Status and handoff – ancient-texts translations

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> **The first file a new session reads after `translation-guidelines.md`.** It says where the work stands and how to continue. **Keep it current:** every session that finishes a run, settles a decision or changes the plan updates it in the same commit.

Last updated: 2026-11-02 (**Round 5 complete**: the lead's finalization – the cross-corpus harmonization `harmonization--2026-11-02.md` (two new rules: the echo tag on proper names, one Hebrew for a cognate pair of cousin languages), Ḫedammu (60 lines) added to the fifth-day dossier, the dossier's Illuyanka and Westcar aligned with their corpora, every verifier and `check_bible_quotes.py` over 1,011 files passing; report `reports/round-5/final.md`. Round 5's six runs: Vedic Genesis, the Hurro-Hittite myths, the Ugaritic epics, "Words in stone", the Cuthaean Legend + the Poor Man + the fables, the Egyptian tales – about 8,100 lines.)

1. Starting a session (local or Claude Cloud)

To run a whole round from one prompt (Claude Cloud): start a session with `ancient-translations: orchestrate Round <N>`. It becomes the parent (title `Round<N>: …`), creates the round's branch `translation-round-<N>`, and runs each run as its own child session (`Round<N>/Run<M>: …`) on its own branch, within the quota's time ranges, as guidelines §5.1–§5.1c describe (reports in `reports/round-<N>/`); at the end it squashes the round into `main` as one commit, and you hear from it. To run a single run yourself instead: `ancient-translations: Round <N>, run <M>`.

1. **Sync with origin** – on `main`, or on the session's work branch (§5.1b; a resumed cloud session wakes up on an old checkout: the session operator's report says so). Then run `../../claude/quota-related-instructions.ts` and follow it (§5.1).

2. **Restore the git-ignored sources:** most raw sources are not in git, since the repo is public (guidelines §8).

```
python3 -I tools/sources_sync.py status          # what is missing (work tier
python3 -I tools/sources_sync.py fetch           # restore it (about 5–15 min
python3 -I tools/sources_sync.py verify          # compare with the copies th
```

   - `FAILED … blocked by the network allowlist? host X`: that host must be added to the cloud environment's
     allowed domains, which only the user can do (claude.ai UI). Tell the user; continue with what you have.
   - `pdftotext is not installed`: `apt-get install -y poppler-utils` (or ask the user to add it to the environment's setup script).
   - `CHANGED`: the online edition changed since we used it (eBL and ORACC are living editions). Don't silently
     rebase a finished translation on it: note it in the project's `project.md` and tell the user.
   - Known on 2026-10-21: eBL changed **Atra-ḫasīs MB "Priv"** (`eBL/Atrahasis-MB-Priv/`) since the flood corpus used
     it (`CHANGED`): compare the new reading edition with `סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/4-נוסחי-מבול-אכדיים-נוספים/` and
     note what moved. Lenzi 2023's PDF always shows `CHANGED` (the repository re-stamps it); its text is identical.
   - The archive tier (`--all`) needs downloads from archive.org, which redirects to changing hosts
     (`dn….archive.org`): with a "Limited" allowlist they fail. It is not needed for translating.
3. **Read** `translation-guidelines.md` in full, then this file, then the plan (`curated-translation-candidates.md`,
   the current round's plan), then the corpus you will work in (`corpus.md`, `renderings.md`, the `project.md` files).

2. Pace and git (guidelines §5.1–§5.1c; the user's rules of 2026-10-30, replacing every earlier usage rule)

- **Two time ranges a week, nothing outside them:** run `../../claude/quota-related-instructions.ts` as-is (an executable; it
  prints the rules and this week's times). **A – Shabbat** (1 hour before it enters → 4 hours before it exits): the 5-hour limit
  may be used up, a weekly warning stops; one agent at a time. **B – Monday night** (Monday 00:00 Israel time → the
  weekly reset, Monday 07:00 UTC): everything left, warnings included; up to three agents, on independent tracks.

- **The gate** before every heavy step and on every wake-up: `get_session` → `../../claude/quota-related-instructions.ts check '<rate_limit_info JSON>'` → `GO … agents=<n>` or `WAIT <time>` (push, pause, end the turn; §5.1c says who
  wakes whom).
- **Phase the work:** think and write the scripts with one agent; run every independent script at once in the
  background (start `tools/sources_sync.py fetch` first thing); process the results.
- **Sub-agents cannot start sub-agents** (guidelines §5.1): a coordinator started as a sub-agent translates its texts
  itself. For real translator chains, make the session itself the coordinator, or launch sub-sessions (§5.1c).
- **Git:** every session works and pushes only on its own branch (`translation-round-<N>`, `…-run-<M>`,
  `…-run-<M>-sub-<K>`; `tools/branches.py`), commits locally often, pushes seldom, and squashes into its parent's
  branch when done; `main` gets one commit per round. Round 4 finishes on `main`. Never commit `docs/` at the repo
  root (the RTL editor regenerates it; the user commits it).

3. What is done

All of it is a **first draft**: complete, verified by script, three review passes, but not yet reviewed by the user.

Corpus	Projects	Lines	Verify with
`סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/`	Atra-ḫasīs I–III, Gilg. XI 1–208, the Sumerian Flood Story, the other Akkadian versions, Berossus + Abydenus, flood references	(see `corpus.md`)	per project (see `corpus.md`)
`סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/`	1 Enūma eliš I–VII; 2 the creation and Eden companions (7 texts); 3 Bird and Fish; 4 Enki and the World Order; 5 the Farmer's Instructions; 6 Hoe and Plough; 7 Summer and Winter (5–7 Round 3 run 1)	3,435	`1-אנומה-אליש/verify.py`, `2-.../verify.py`, `sumerian_tools.py verify 3...7 --strict`
`חוקים-ובריתות/`	1 Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty; 2 Hammurabi (§66–99 missing in the base text); 3 Eshnunna; 4 MAL A; 5 Lipit-Ištar; 6 Ur-Namma; 7 MAL B; **8 the Hittite Laws** (HL1 = CHiL CTH 291.2, HL 1–100; HL2 = CTH 292, HL 101–200, our TLHdig composite; HLPT = the late parallel text KBo 6.4); **9 the Instructions for Temple Personnel** (CTH 264, our TLHdig composite) (8–9 Round 4 run 6, the folder's first Hittite texts)	6,731 + 1,419	`laws_*.py`; `../tools/hittite_tools.py verify HL1 HL2 HLPT IN --strict`
`טקסי-שילוח-וטיהור/`	1 the Hittite elimination rituals: Ašḫella (CTH 394), Uḫḫamuwa (CTH 410), Puliša (CTH 407), Ambazzi (CTH 391.1–2), from the HPM editions (Round 4 run 6; a new corpus for sending-away and purification rites)	481	`../tools/hittite_tools.py verify AS UH PU AM AM2 --strict`, `selftest`
`אפוס-גילגמש/`	SB I–X, XI 209–328, XII; the OB tablets	3,217	`verify.py --strict`

Corpus	Projects	Lines	Verify with
ספרות-החכמה-והצדיק-הסובל/	1 Ludlul I–V; 2 the Babylonian Theodicy; 3 the Great Prayer to Šamaš; 4 Counsels of Wisdom; 5 the Dialogue of Pessimism; 6 the Instructions of Šuruppag (Sumerian; 3–6 Round 3 run 4); **7 the Poor Man of Nippur; 8 the fables** (Palm and Vine, the Poplar, Ox and Horse, the Spider, the Wren; 7–8 Round 5 run 5)	1,562 + 615	`wisdom_tools.py verify --strict`
קינות-על-ערים/	1 the Lament for Ur; 2 the Curse of Agade (OB + Ur III)	763	`lament_tools.py verify --strict`
בניין-המקדש/	1 the Gudea Cylinders A–B	1,300	`temple_tools.py verify GU --strict`
העולם-התחתון/	1 the Descent of Ištar (SB + NA); 2 Inana's Descent; 3 Nergal and Ereškigal (MB Amarna + SB); 4 Bilgameš, Enkidu and the Netherworld (five recensions; the source of Gilg. XII) (3–4 Round 3 run 5); 5 Erra and Išum, Tablet I (eBL; II–V not edited on eBL yet; Round 4 run 5)	1,673	`netherworld_tools.py verify IS|IN|NE|GEN|ER --strict`
אגדות-מלכים/	1 Enmerkar and the Lord of Aratta; 2 the Sargon Birth Legend (on King 1907 only: check against Westenholz 1997); 3 Etana (all six eBL versions, Round 3 run 2); **4 the Cuthaean Legend of Narām-Sîn** (all five eBL versions, Round 5 run 5)	1,275 + 345	`kings_tools.py verify EA --strict`, `… verify SB --strict`, `… verify ET --strict`, `… verify CL --strict`
קולות-היום-יום/	1 OB / Old Akkadian love lyrics and incantations (LAOS 4, 25 texts); 2 Sumerian proverbs (coll. 1 complete, selections of 2–3); 3 Lu-diĝira + eight Sumerian letters	1,513	`kol_tools.py verify LOVE PROV LET --strict`
נבואה-ומלכות/	1 the Assyrian prophecies (SAA 9 1–11, all eleven texts); 2 Advice to a Prince (eBL `L/2/5`)	707	`prophecy_tools.py verify --strict`

Corpus	Projects	Lines	Verify with
`כשפים-ולחשים/`	1 Maqlû, Tablets I–VIII and the Ritual Tablet (eBL `Mag/1/1`; Round 3 run 6)	1,595	`maqlu_tools.py verify --strict`
`חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/`	1 the Instruction of Amenemope (551); 2 Egyptian creation: Merikare E 130–138, Pyramid Texts 571, 486, 527, 600, the Memphite Theology (115); 3 the Book of the Heavenly Cow (Seti I, 95 columns) (Round 4 run 3); **4 the Two Brothers (185); 5 pWestcar in full (305; 2,21–4,7 = the fifth-day dossier's WC, identical by `verify WE`); 6 the Book of the Dead 125 (pNu, 115); 7 Sinuhe (R 1–23 + B 1–311, 334); 8 the Shipwrecked Sailor (191)** (4–8 Round 5 run 6)	761 + 1,130	`egypt_tools.py verify --strict`, `selftest`
`הסיודוס/`	1 the Theogony (all 1,042 lines of Evelyn-White's text, with Galen's 929a–t); 2 the Works and Days (all 831 lines; WD 310 is not in the base) – the folder's first Archaic Greek corpus, with the LXX layer (Round 4 run 4)	1,873	`hesiod_tools.py verify --strict`, `selftest`

Corpus	Projects	Lines	Verify with
`מיתוסים-אוגריתיים/`	1 the Baal Cycle, KTU 1.1–1.6; 2 the short myths and charms (KTU 1.23, 1.24, 1.114, 1.100, 1.107, 1.108, 1.82, 1.83); 3 the fifth-day dossier (six excerpts: Egyptian, Greek, Hittite, Vedic, Old Norse, Old Japanese; + pWestcar and the Apophis spells, Round 4 run 3; + **Ḫedammu**, HD, 60 lines copied from the myth corpus and kept identical by `hittite_tools.py verify HE`, the Round 5 finalization) (Round 4 run 1); **4 Aqhat (KTU 1.17–1.19); 5 Kirta (1.14–1.16; readings: EUPT 2025, CC BY-SA); 6 the Rephaim (1.20–1.22) and the royal funerary liturgy 1.161; 7 rituals: 1.40 (atonement), 1.119, 1.39** (4–7 Round 5 run 3)	1,749 + 160 + 1,424	`ugarit_tools.py verify --strict`, `3-.../dossier_tools.py verify --strict`
`הוודה-והאווסטה/`	the folder's first Sanskrit and Avestan corpus (Round 5 run 1): 1 the Rigveda's creation hymns (10.129, 10.121, 10.72, 10.190, 10.90); 2 Indra and the serpent (1.32; the fifth-day dossier's excerpt aligned by script); 3 the Indo-Iranian flood (ŚB 1.8.1, MBh 3.185, Vd 2); 4 the binding (AB 7.13–18, ŚB 1.2.3.6–9, Kaṭha Upaniṣad adhyāya 1); 5 Yama and the dead (10.10, 10.14–18); 6 the gambler and the frogs (10.34, 7.103)	1,312	`vedic_tools.py verify --strict`, `selftest`

Corpus	Projects	Lines	Verify with
`מיתוסים-חתיים-וחוריים/`	the Hurro-Hittite and Old Anatolian myths (Round 5 run 2): 1 Illuyanka (CTH 321; IL 8–17 = the fifth-day dossier's excerpt, kept identical by `verify IL`) and Ḫedammu (CTH 348.I.1–29); 2 the Song of Emergence (CTH 344) and Ullikummi (CTH 345.I); 3 the Song of Release, Hittite side (CTH 789; our TLHdig composite); 4 Zalpa (CTH 3.1; our composite), Appu (CTH 360), Elkunirša and Ašertu (CTH 342); 5 Telipinu (CTH 324.1); bases the HPM "Mythen der Hethiter" editions (CC BY-SA)	3,164	`../tools/hittite_tools.py verify IL HE KU UL SR ZA AP EL TE --strict`, `selftest`
`מילים-באבן/`	Northwest Semitic inscriptions (Round 5 run 4): 1 the Mesha stele (Moabite, 34); 2 the ʻAjrud pithos blessings 8.017, 8.021 and Ketef Hinnom II (Hebrew, 17); 3 the Mesad Hashavyahu ostracon and the Gezer calendar (Hebrew, 22); 4 the Marseille and Carthage tariffs (Punic, 32) – Hebrew and Moabite as **readings** (square script + vocalized reading + apparatus), Punic **translated**	113	`מילים-באבן/stone_tools.py verify --strict`, `selftest`

Checked at the Round 5 finalization (2026-11-02): every verifier above – the Round 5 tools included (`vedic_tools.py`, `hittite_tools.py` all 18 keys, `ugarit_tools.py`, `stone_tools.py`, `kings_tools.py CL`, `wisdom_tools.py`, `egypt_tools.py`, `dossier_tools.py`), `--strict` where the tool takes it, and every selftest – and `tools/check_bible_quotes.py` over all 1,011 `.md` files of the folder passed after the harmonization (`reports/round-5/final.md`). **The print layout** (`layout/`, from `main`, 2026-10-31): the 44 older translations have a layout module (`translation.rtl.layout.ts`, all by rule); Round 5's new ones have none yet and print by the folder's default rule, with no overflowing row – a layout session's work (`layout/layout-guidelines.md`).

Checked at the Round 4 finalization (2026-10-30): every verifier above (all keys, `--strict` where the tool takes it, the selftests) and `tools/check_bible_quotes.py` over all 708 `.md` files of the folder passed after the harmonization – including the Round 4 rows (Ugaritic, the dossier, Egyptian, Hesiod, Erra I, the Hittite texts). The dossier's parallels tables are now generated by the corpus builder (`מיתוסים-אוגריתיים/build_parallels_index.py`).

Every finished translation has a print stub in `הדפסה/` (guidelines §7.4). Each corpus has a `parallels-index.md`
with its key findings at the top.

4. What is next

Round 2 is finished (runs 5–7, 2026-10-21, in parallel in Claude Cloud), and the cross-corpus splits it left were
settled on 2026-10-21 (§6). **Next: Round 3** (`curated-translation-candidates.md`, "Round 3 plan"): six runs in six
different corpora, **one cloud session per run** (start each with `ancient-translations: Round 3, run N`), in the
table's order; inside a run, its sub-agents strictly one at a time (quotas, §2):

Run	Texts	Corpus
1	The Farmer's Instructions, Hoe and Plough, Summer and Winter (Gen 8:22, 3:17–19, 4:2–5)	the creation corpus, projects 5–7: **done (first draft), 2026-10-22**, 607 lines
2	Etana (Gen 11:4, 30:14–16, Deut 32:11)	`אגדות-מלכים/` project 3: **done (first draft), 2026-10-22**, 585 lines
3	The Assyrian prophecies (SAA 9) + Advice to a Prince (Deut 13, 17, 18; "fear not")	new `נבואה-ומלכות/`: **done (first draft), 2026-10-22**, 707 lines
4	The Great Prayer to Šamaš, Counsels of Wisdom, the Dialogue of Pessimism, Šuruppag in full	the wisdom corpus, projects 3–6: **done (first draft), 2026-10-22**, 740 lines
5	Nergal and Ereškigal, Bilgameš, Enkidu and the Netherworld (Gen 28:12; 1 Sam 28)	`העולם-התחתון/` projects 3–4: **done (first draft), 2026-10-22**, 883 lines
6	Maqlû I–VIII + the Ritual Tablet (Ex 22:17, Deut 18:10–11)	new `כשפים-ולחשים/`: **done (first draft), 2026-10-23**, 1,595 lines

Round 3 is complete (2026-10-23). **Next: Round 4, run 1** (below).

Round 4 (approved by the user, 2026-10-22; starts when Round 3 is finished): `curated-translation-candidates.md`,
"Round 4 plan". It merges the Mesopotamian texts left after Round 3 with the first non-Mesopotamian texts from the world
survey (`curated-translation-candidates--world.md`), ranked together. **One run at a time** (guidelines §5.1), started with
`ancient-translations: Round 4, run N`:

1. the Ugaritic myths (the Baal Cycle + the short myths and charms), with the fifth-day dossier – for Gen 1:21, now: **done (first draft), 2026-10-23**, `מיתוסים-אוגריתיים/` (report `reports/round-4/run-1.md`);
2. the Edict of Ammiṣaduqa – only if an open base text is found (none on 2026-10-22);
3. Egyptian wisdom and creation (Amenemope, Merikare, the Heavenly Cow, the Memphite Theology; base AED-TEI): **done (first draft), 2026-10-24**, `חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/` (report `reports/round-4/run-3.md`);
4. Hesiod (Theogony + Works and Days; base Perseus + treebank): **done (first draft), 2026-10-24**, `הסיודוס/` (report `reports/round-4/run-4.md`);
5. Erra and Išum (eBL): **done (first draft) for Tablet I, 2026-10-24**, project 5 of `העולם-התחתון/` (191 lines; Tablets II–V are not edited on eBL yet and wait for it: `sources/_records-only--Erra-and-Ishum-II-V/`; report `reports/round-4/run-5.md`);
6. Hittite law and ritual: **done (first draft), 2026-10-30** – the Hittite Laws (both tablets + the late parallel text, 1,107 lines; project 8 of `חוקים-ובריתות/`), the Instructions for Temple Personnel (312; project 9), the elimination rituals of Ašḫella, Uḫḫamuwa, Puliša and Ambazzi (481; the new corpus `טקסי-שילוח-וטיהור/`); bases: the HPM editions (CHiL, BESRIT; CC BY-SA) and our composites from TLHdig 0.3 (CC BY 4.0); `tools/hittite_tools.py` (report `reports/round-4/run-6.md`). Ḫedammu (for the fifth-day dossier) not done: not cheap (no HPM clause edition found), left for a later round.

Round 4 is complete (2026-10-30): runs 1, 3, 4 and 6 done; run 5 partial (Erra I; II–V wait for eBL); run 2 skipped (the Edict of Ammiṣaduqa waits on access). The lead's finalization: the cross-corpus harmonization of the round's splits (`harmonization--2026-10-30.md`, §6 below), every verifier, the shared files; report `reports/round-4/final.md`; open questions for the user: `reports/round-4/questions-for-user.md`.

Next: Round 5 – planned and started by the orchestrator (the parent session) in a separate session, per the user's instruction of 2026-10-30; it is the first round on branches (guidelines §5.1b). Run 1 (Vedic Genesis) **done (first draft), 2026-10-30**: 1,312 `הוודה-והאווסטה/` lines (report `reports/round-5/run-1.md`). Run 2 (the Hurro-Hittite myths) **done (first draft), 2026-10-31**: 3,164 `מיתוסים-חתיים-וחוריים/` lines (report `reports/round-5/run-2.md`); for the lead's finalization: Ḫedammu into the fifth-day dossier, the 4 pending dossier revisions of the myth renderings §H8, the splits of the report. Run 3 (the Ugaritic epics and rituals) **done (first draft), 2026-10-31**: `מיתוסים-אוגריתיים/` projects 4–7, 1,424 lines, the whole selection plus KTU 1.161, 1.119, 1.39, all

independently reviewed (report `reports/round-5/run-3.md`); the dossier untouched. Run 4 ("Words in stone") **done (first draft), 2026-10-31**: the new corpus 113 `מילים-באבן/` entries – the Mesha stele, the ʿAjrud blessings, Ketef Hinnom II, Mesad Hashavyahu, the Gezer calendar (readings), the Marseille and Carthage tariffs (translated), independently reviewed (report `reports/round-5/run-4.md`); Tell Fekheriye, Sefire, Deir ʿAllā and Khirbet el-Qom recorded – their editions are on Persée, which a person must save (`sources/_records-only--Words-in-stone/`). Run 5 (Mesopotamian literature from eBL) **done (first draft), 2026-10-31**: the whole selection, 960 lines – the Cuthaean Legend (`אגדות-מלכים/4-אגדת-כותה/`), the Poor Man of Nippur and the fables (`8 ,...-7/הסובל-והצדיק-החכמה-ספרות-...`) (report `reports/round-5/run-5.md`). Run 6 (the Egyptian tales) **done (first draft), 2026-11-01**: the whole selection, 1,130 lines – the Two Brothers, pWestcar in full, BD 125, Sinuhe, the Shipwrecked Sailor, projects 4–8 of `חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/` (the tales share its base, tool and renderings: renderings §11), each independently reviewed (report `reports/round-5/run-6.md`); the dossier untouched (one pending revision of WC 2,22 for the lead).

Round 5 is complete (2026-11-02): all six runs done; the lead's finalization – the harmonization (`harmonization--2026-11-02.md`, §6 below), Ḫedammu into the fifth-day dossier, every verifier, the shared files; report `reports/round-5/final.md`; questions for the user: `reports/round-5/questions-for-user.md`. **Next: Round 6** – its candidates are the "Later" list of the Round 5 plan (`curated-translation-candidates.md`); the orchestrator plans it.

Quick wins between the runs: Šūpê-amēlu (eBL has no lines yet); the fables and the Poor Man are done (Round 5 run 5). Each new language needs a converter, a
name table, renderings with reserved-word gates and a translator brief before its first line.

Parallel sessions edit the shared files only at the end of their run, in one commit; they meet at `tools/branches.py finish` (guidelines §5.1b). The user's review of the Round 1–2 drafts can go on alongside. The Round 2 runs, for the record:

Run	Texts	Base text	New corpus
5	**The Descent of Ištar** + **Inana's Descent to the Netherworld**	eBL (Ištar); ETCSL 1.4.1 + ORACC (Inana)	the netherworld: **done (first draft), 2026-10-21**, `העולם-התחתון/`
6	**Enmerkar and the Lord of Aratta** + **the Sargon Birth Legend**	ETCSL 1.8.2.3 + ORACC; King 1907 (public domain) or a newer open edition	Gen 11 and Exod 2: **done (first draft), 2026-10-21**, `אגדות-מלכים/`
7	**OB love lyrics** + **Sumerian proverbs** (a selection) + **OB letters** (a selection)	ORACC AkkLove / SEAL; ETCSL 6.1; ORACC/CDLI letters	everyday voices: **done (first draft), 2026-10-21**, `קולות-היום-יום/` (the OB Akkadian letters not obtained: CDLI 503)

Runs 5, 6 and 7 were independent (different corpora) and ran in parallel under the cloud's former special allowance,
each as its own coordinator with its own sequential translator chain (since 2026-10-22: one at a time, §2). Each run is briefed as in §5 below.

5. The run brief (how every run so far was briefed)

A coordinator (one agent per run) gets this brief, adapted to its texts:

- **Read** `translation-guidelines.md` in full (binding; the translators too, with the ★ rules of §5.2 in their
  brief); `STATUS.md`; `sources-registry.md` before securing sources, `tools.md` before writing a tool; the plan row; the newest corpora as models for
  structure and tools (`בניין-המקדש/` with `temple_tools.py`, `קינות-על-ערים/` with `lament_tools.py`, `ספרות-החכמה-והצדיק-הסובל/` with `wisdom_tools.py`, the creation corpus's `sumerian_tools.py` and `translator-brief--sumerian.md`). The existing corpora's renderings are binding for shared names, formulas and
  terms; for the still-open cross-corpus choices (§6) follow the most recent corpus and flag conflicts.
- **Both purposes (guidelines §1):** the Bible comparison (with the echo-control tags and `check_bible_quotes.py`)
  and "the soul of the ancients", equal in standing: the **הערות** explain the text on its own terms, even where
  there is no biblical parallel.

- **Process:** the §5 workflow. Create the corpus folder (`corpus.md`, `renderings.md`, `parallels-index.md`, one
  project folder per text). Record every new source per §2.2 and §4, add its recipe to `sources/fetch-recipes.tsv`
  if it is git-ignored and run `tools/sources_sync.py snapshot`, and add new hosts to `domains.txt`. Fix the
  renderings before drafting. Draft unvocalized and plene. Translators as sub-agents, each with the guidelines, the
  renderings, a translator brief and an exact line range; the coordinator merges their proposals into the renderings
  between translators. Three review passes; `translation.rtl.md` generated by script and verified identical to the
  `>` lines; `check_bible_quotes.py` on every file; translators print every verse before quoting it; print stubs.
- **Finish:** record what was learned where the guidelines' top box says (sources → `sources-registry.md`, tools
  → `tools.md`, decisions and false friends → §6.7, a lesson → one line in §5.2 + its story in `history.md`, a
  changelog line in `history.md`); update the plan row and this file; `git add` only its own files (never `-A`, never `docs/`,
  `claude-sessions/`, `__pycache__/` or git-ignored content); commit ("Ancient-texts translations: ...") on the run's own branch, and push it (guidelines §5.1b).
- **Report:** what was translated and verified; key findings for the Bible; what the texts show of the ancient
  mind; open decisions for the user; anything skipped or failed.

6. Open decisions

The user's standing rules (2026-10-21): no purchases (paid or lending-only sources stay records-only: e.g. Westenholz 1997
is not bought, so the Sargon Birth Legend stays on King 1907, with its caveat in the project); **decide minor things
yourself** (renderings, harmonizing splits between corpora, scope details) and record each decision where it belongs
(the corpus `renderings.md`, the `project.md`, this table). Only major choices go to the user.

The cross-corpus splits were settled on 2026-10-21 (by the lead, under the rule above): the decisions, and the words kept
by sense, are in `translation-guidelines.md` §6.7 ("Cross-corpus harmonization"); each corpus's `renderings.md` lists the

lines it changed, and the `project.md` files mark their open decisions settled. All verifiers and `check_bible_quotes.py`
passed afterwards.

The cross-corpus splits of Round 3 were settled on 2026-10-23 (by the lead, under the user's rule): the table, with
every change, the lines it touched and the splits kept with their reasons, is **`harmonization--2026-10-23.md`**;
guidelines §6.7 sums it up; each corpus's `renderings.md` has a "2026-10-23 harmonization" line. Applied in three batches,
one agent at a time; all verifiers and `check_bible_quotes.py` passed afterwards. The last decision left for the user,
šipru "work", was settled by the user the same day: `מְלָאכָה` in every corpus (guidelines §6.7).

For the user, from the world survey (2026-10-21; `curated-translation-candidates--world.md` §7):

1. ~~Widen the work beyond Mesopotamia, and approve Round 4?~~ **Settled 2026-10-22:** yes – the merged Round 4 plan.
2. ~~Hebrew and Moabite inscriptions~~ **Settled 2026-10-22** (left to the lead): transcription + vocalized reading +
   apparatus (guidelines §6.7).
3. ~~A [typological] tag~~ **Settled by the user, 2026-10-22: no special tag** (guidelines §6.4).

The project is global (the user, 2026-10-22): "focusing on the 'essence of antiquity'" (guidelines §1). Round 4 keeps
its approved order; from Round 5 on, candidates are ranked with that focus first.

Still open:

Decision	Now	Where
The Sargon Birth Legend's base text	King 1907 (our transcription from the page images)	Westenholz 1997 is not to be bought (the user's rule): check again if an open copy appears
EST's transliterations (found by Round 3 run 3)	`tools/cdl2md.py` doubled compound logograms until 2026-10-22: 118 + 41 lines in the EST source files and their copies in `1/בריתות-חוקים-.../` (the Hebrew is unaffected)	regenerate the EST source files with the fixed converter when ORACC is reachable (`tools.md`)
The per-text open decisions	see each `project.md`	minor ones: the next session on that corpus decides them (the user's rule)

The cross-corpus splits of Round 4 were settled on 2026-10-30 (by the lead, under the user's rule): nine changes and the kept splits, with three cross-language principles (a cognate reservation protects a Semitic text's own cognate, not the common vocabulary of a non-Semitic corpus; a loanword's Hebrew belongs to its source language; inside one language the cognate keeps the Hebrew, a formula wins, a Hittite Akkadogram takes its Akkadian word's Hebrew) – table `harmonization--2026-10-30.md`; guidelines §6.7; a "2026-10-30 harmonization" line in each touched corpus's `renderings.md`. Applied in two batches, one agent at a time; every verifier and `check_bible_quotes.py` passed afterwards.

The cross-corpus splits of Round 5 were settled on 2026-11-02 (by the lead, under the user's rule): eight rows of changes (Av. *dātar* `מעמיד`; *aggu* / *aggiš* `קצף`; *kupri-* `כֹּפֶר` licensed; the Hittite F8 / F18 scoped; the name-tag rule; Westcar's notation; the dossier's Illuyanka) and the kept splits with reasons (SISKUR, *ḫarnink-*, *šâlu* / *erēšu*, the palm …) – table `harmonization--2026-11-02.md`; guidelines §6.4 (the name tags) and §6.7; a "2026-11-02 harmonization" line in each touched corpus's `renderings.md`. Applied in two batches at once (range B, two agents on independent files); every verifier and `check_bible_quotes.py` passed afterwards. **Open for the user** (Round 5): the Persée PDFs of Tell Fekheriye, Sefire and Deir ʿAllā (a person must save them), and Wikipedia (CC BY-SA) as an interim base for three inscriptions (accepted meanwhile) – `reports/round-5/questions-for-user.md`.

The decisions settled earlier (2026-10-18) are in the Gilgameš renderings §12, `חוקים-בריתות/corpus.md` and the
flood corpus renderings.